

Ripped Body, Rich Life Blueprint EP 309

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Executive Summary

Episode 309 of the Victory Talk podcast delivers 7 practical fat loss hacks, a live stock market recap covering semiconductors and individual names, and a detailed 5-stage roadmap to scale an online fitness business from zero to \$100K/month.

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Intro, Sponsors & Show Setup 0:00

- Episode 309 of the Victory Talk podcast; technical audio issues at the start
- **Sponsor 1 — Live AI Training (Sunday, 2 PM EST):**
 - Brandon will show how to grow an online fitness business using AI
 - Topics: getting more followers, getting more clients, creating content, making sales, and training clients with AI
 - He has been a personal trainer for 27 years, one of the first online trainers (~2009–2010)
 - Q&A will be answered live; register via first link in description
- **Sponsor 2 — Online Coaching Applications:**
 - Brandon is taking on personal online clients for custom meal and diet plans plus accountability
 - Fill out application in description; automated text follows — must reply to that text or he ignores you
- **Sponsor 3 — "Thot Repellent" (running joke):**

- Fictional spray "developed by ballers for ballers" to repel undesirable women while attracting good ones
- Super chats from viewers go toward its "development fund"; link not yet available

Mindset: Raising Your Floor, Not Your Ceiling t=355s

- Prompted by a super chat from viewer "Z the Man" who performs well in survival mode but coasts when comfortable
- **The Floor/Ceiling Framework:**
 - Every person has a mental *floor* (income level that triggers panic and hustle) and a *ceiling* (income level that triggers comfort and coasting)
 - Example: floor = \$5K/month (can't pay rent), ceiling = \$10K/month (feels like enough)
 - People cycle between these two levels indefinitely — hustle up, coast down, repeat
 - Brandon has coached students stuck in this exact cycle for *years*; some students in his high-ticket program make over \$1M/year while others with the same tenure are stuck at \$10K/month
- **The Solution — Raise the Floor, Not the Ambition:**
 - "You will not rise to your ambitions. You will fall to your standards."
 - Trying to be more ambitious doesn't work; you need to raise the *minimum* you'll accept
 - Reframe from "I want to make \$10K" → "I will make no less than \$10K" — treat it as a standard, not a goal
 - You'll still have a new ceiling above that, but the whole cycle shifts upward
 - Keep raising the floor repeatedly to steadily increase income over time

Fat Loss Hack 1: Mix Up Your Cardio to Make It Fun t=853s

- Caloric deficit (burning more calories than you consume) is the mechanism of fat loss — "hacks" are ways to get into that deficit faster or easier
- Most people hate traditional cardio (stairmaster, elliptical) because it's boring and arduous
- **Strategies to make cardio more enjoyable:**
 - Play video games during cardio — Brandon plays Call of Duty Mobile on an iPad while riding his exercise bike
 - Combines dopamine spike (games) with something he dislikes (cardio)
 - Watch football or other TV shows on a screen positioned near an exercise bike
 - Use a **desk bike** (stationary pedaling) during meetings and calls throughout the day
 - Can accumulate several hours of low-intensity cardio passively
 - Prefers desk bike over a walking pad — he fell off the walking pad multiple times when cognitively focused
 - Play outside with kids — scooters, trampoline parks, swimming, running at the playground
 - "I'm not one of these fat dads on the bench with his phone"
 - Track calories burned via Apple Watch or **Oura Ring** (his primary calorie monitoring tool)



Fat Loss Hack 2: Intermittent Fasting + Stimulants t=1188s

- Brandon did **16:8 intermittent fasting** (16-hour fast, 8-hour eating window) for **five consecutive years**
 - Eating window: ~3 PM to 10–11 PM
- **How it works:** Not magic; simply shrinks the eating window, making it hard to overconsume calories
 - Best for people too lazy to track macros — most will inadvertently eat fewer calories than they burn
 - Strategy: push your first meal as late as possible; eat reasonably during the window (not cookies and cake)
- **Stimulants to make fasting easier:**
 - **Caffeine** — suppresses appetite and provides energy when food isn't consumed; nearly universal among people who fast
 - **Bronkaid** — an OTC asthma medication containing **ephedra**
 - Ephedra is one of the few supplements proven to burn fat
 - Was in nearly every fat burner in the 1990s (Hydroxycut, Oxy, etc.) until the FDA banned it from bodybuilding supplements (some deaths reported)
 - Still available OTC at pharmacies — must show ID (no prescription needed)
 - Fat burning is a two-part process: **lipolysis** (fat cells broken into fatty acids) + **oxidation** (body uses fatty acids for energy)
 - Studies show Bronkaid increases lipolysis; it also provides energy, so it's a "double whammy"
 - Caffeine + Bronkaid together strongly blunt hunger and provide energy
 - Other fasting-safe drinks: black coffee (~5 cal, negligible), pre-workout, diet soda, water
- **Side note on Bronkaid from a viewer:** Two pills/day caused drowsiness and nausea
 - Drowsiness is not a normal side effect; nausea can be
 - Recommendation: start with one pill, and **drink more water** — stimulants are diuretics; dehydration causes headaches and lethargy (same mechanism as a hangover)
 - Brandon drinks 1–2 gallons of water daily



Fat Loss Hack 3: Eat More Green Leafy Vegetables t=1526s

- Green leafy vegetables are **not calorically dense** but are very filling — a "cheat code" for satiety
 - Examples: spinach, kale, broccoli
 - Can eat nearly unlimited amounts without consuming many calories
- Only **12% of Americans** get their daily recommended fiber intake (per WHO) — most people don't eat enough vegetables
- Brandon eats two large salads per day even on keto (11 years on keto)
- **Mechanism:** Fill your stomach with low-calorie food → less room for high-calorie junk
 - Reduces cravings for sugar/sweets because stomach is already full

- Hard to get fat eating vegetables and meat: "We did not rise to the top of the food chain for you to eat Dunkin' Donuts"

🚫 Fat Loss Hack 4: Eliminate Liquid Calories t=1668s

- Liquid calories are a "silent assassin" — they don't create satiety but add significant calories
 - A Starbucks cocoa macchiato latte (grande/venti) can be ~500 calories
 - Soda is similarly high in liquid calories
- **Rule: Only drink zero-calorie beverages**
 - Water, sparkling water, pre-workout, diet soda
- **On artificial sweeteners / aspartame safety:**
 - Study cited: a 200-lb man would need to drink 16–18 cans of diet soda *every day for the rest of his life* before experiencing negative health effects
 - If still concerned, just drink water
- **Fruit juice is a scam:**
 - Essentially a glass of concentrated sugar with minimal vitamins
 - Equivalent to drinking Kool-Aid and taking a multivitamin — same calories or more
 - Fructose, glucose, sucrose are the same molecule as table sugar on a molecular level; "natural" doesn't mean healthy
 - Table sugar also comes from a plant (sugar cane) — same thing
- **Only acceptable sugar source:** whole fruit, because fiber mitigates the sugar's negative effects and you consume less sugar than in juice (which is concentrated)
- Dried fruit: not worth addressing — "none of you eat dried fruit on a regular basis"

🧑 Fat Loss Hack 5: Maximize NEAT (Non-Exercise Activity Thermogenesis) t=1909s

- **How the body burns calories — breakdown:**

Source	Description	% of Daily Calories Burned
BMR (Basal Metabolic Rate)	Keeping organs alive, breathing, etc.	~60%
Thermic Effect of Food	Digesting food	~20–30%
Exercise Activity Thermogenesis	Formal workouts	~5–15%
NEAT	All other movement (walking, fidgeting, chores)	~5–15%

- **Why NEAT matters more than intense cardio:**

- Going from 5,000 steps/day (average) to **20,000 steps/day** burns an **extra ~1,000 calories/day** for a 200-lb, 6'2" person
- Running a mile burns only ~100 calories with significant strain on joints, CNS, and energy
- High-intensity cardio negatively affects the **central nervous system** (especially with age), degrades gym performance, and triggers **leptin and ghrelin** (hunger hormones) — body compensates by increasing appetite or reducing NEAT elsewhere
- NEAT does NOT trigger these compensatory mechanisms; it's cumulative and feels normal to the body
- Low impact — doesn't damage joints or hurt recovery
- **Target: 20,000 steps/day**
 - Raises NEAT contribution from ~5–10% to ~25% of daily calorie burn
- **Practical ways to increase NEAT:**
 - Track steps — iPhone does it automatically
 - Walk instead of driving short distances
 - Take stairs instead of elevator/escalator
 - Walk with family, kids, significant other, or dog
 - Morning ocean walks (Brandon in Miami — sees dolphins, manatees, peacocks)
 - Take phone calls while walking
 - Walk around balconies or pacing while thinking
- **Bonus — build muscle to raise BMR:**
 - More muscle = higher BMR (more calories burned at rest)
 - Since BMR is 60% of total calorie burn, this is the highest-leverage body composition change
 - Lift heavy; prioritize the weight room



Fat Loss Hack 6 & 7: Track Your Calories and Macros with AI [t=2391s](#)

- Brandon calls calorie/macro tracking "the most important thing" — if you take one thing from the video, make it this
- **Duke University study:** Participants tracked calories and macros for 90 days with no diet or workout plan given
 - Result: lost an average of **5 pounds** just from tracking
 - Reason: awareness creates better decisions — "before you were just putting anything in your mouth"
- Brandon tracked in notebooks before smartphones; switched to **MyFitnessPal** when iPhone apps launched; has tracked for over a decade
- **Current method: Claude AI with a custom prompt**
 - Long prompt syncs with **Apple Health** to pull calories burned
 - Log meals by typing what you ate OR taking a photo of a nutrition label — Claude identifies and logs it automatically

- Provides a **running daily total** of calories consumed, macros (protein/carbs/fat/net carbs), and real-time **caloric deficit**
- Example from his log: Quest protein shake (photo → auto-identified), 9 eggs + 150ml blueberries + 1 oz kale + weighed salad dressing, protein water, protein muffin (7 net carbs)
- End-of-day summary command gives full macro and deficit breakdown
- Brandon's targets: **~2,000 calories/day**, **1g protein per pound of bodyweight** (~200g), net carbs under 50g (keto)
- **Fat loss math:**
 - 1 lb of fat = 3,500 calories
 - To lose 1 lb/week → 500 calorie daily deficit
 - To lose 2 lbs/week → 1,000 calorie daily deficit
- **To get the Claude prompt:** DM Brandon on Instagram the word **"tracking"** — it's too long to put in the description
- **Bonus tip from Young Candlestick:** Simply get out of the kitchen — stay away from food by working, reading, or doing something else; "out of sight, out of mind"



Market Recap with Young Candlestick t=2891s

- Greg ("Young Candlestick") is a CMT (Chartered Market Technician) who trades live with members of **Victory Trades**
- **South Korea market (EWY):** Down **12.2%** in one day — bled into US markets
 - US context: S&P 500 halts trading at -7% for 1 hour; shuts down for the day at -10% (happened multiple times during COVID)
- **US market overview:**
 - S&P 500: -1.5%
 - NASDAQ (QQQ): -3.5%
 - Semiconductors (SMH): **-7% in one day**
- **Greg's market thesis:**
 - End of June (last 1–2 weeks) tends to be more bearish
 - Expects possible wedge pattern: lower highs and lower lows, then potential breakout in July/August
 - If breakout fails, could unwind the big rally from recent lows
 - No strong conviction on broad market; prefers individual stock names
- **Day trading tip on gap-down opens:**
 - Two-thirds of the time, a big gap down produces a sharp morning bounce
 - Reason: put buyers take quick profits; investors buy the dip simultaneously
 - Victory Trades made "a ton of money" trading futures on the morning bounce
 - Strategy: enter trade → immediately set stop-loss → trail stop-loss upward as price rises → don't force a profit target, let it run

- **Individual stock takes:**

Stock	Ticker	View
Service Now	NOW	Bought calls at prior day lows; sold next morning for 100% overnight gain
Microsoft	MSFT	Greg is slightly underwater; expected support at \$400 that didn't hold — may cut
Meta	META	Breaking down; bearish below \$556
Google	GOOGL	Selling off slightly but holding up better; preferred over SpaceX
Tesla	TSLA	Breaking back below \$400; at ~\$380; looks like further downside
Amazon	AMZN	At bounce zone; if it doesn't bounce here, more downside
NBIS	NBIS	One of the best-performing stocks; selling bullish put credit spreads; still strong
XBI (biotech ETF)	XBI	Breaking out even while broader market struggles
Nvidia	NVDA	Big gap down; if it takes out \$198 → could sell to \$180; \$180 is a dip-buy zone
SpaceX	SPCX	IPO'd at ~\$150, hit \$225, pulled back to IPO price; bounced 10%; trade setup below
Copper	—	Gold/silver selling off → copper pulled back; Brandon sold his copper position
SMH (semiconductors ETF)	SMH	Down 7% on double average volume; long-term buy for dollar-cost averaging, especially for younger investors
TSM	TSM	Like at \$420 as a dip-buy
AVGO (Broadcom)	AVGO	Chart not ideal but both Nancy Pelosi and Trump are long — "bipartisan support"

- **SpaceX (SPCX) detailed trade setup:**

- Currently ~\$157; bounced ~10% from IPO open price of ~\$150
- Entry: buy over **\$160**; hard stop-loss at **\$147** (risk ~8–10%)
- Target 1: **\$172–173** (~8% gain)
- Target 2: **\$183** (~14–15% gain)
- Target 3: **\$190** (~20% gain)
- Above \$200 = price discovery; if it holds daily/weekly above \$200 → new all-time highs possible
- Long-term investor zone: **\$153** (current price is basically there)
- Below \$147 = bearish; get out
- Greg's preference: **Google over SpaceX** on a risk-adjusted basis

- Google owns **7% of SpaceX** and has its own AI momentum
- Google has massive advertising revenue (doesn't need Gemini to be profitable)
- Gemini is consistently top-ranked on AI leaderboards; best image, video, and music generation per dollar
- Gemini API is significantly cheaper than Claude, OpenAI, or Anthropic
- SpaceX could 5–10x but could also drop 50–80%; Google is relatively safer
- **Macro context:**
 - Dollar (DXY) strengthening after failing to break support → inversely correlated with gold; gold selling off
 - Strong dollar = less incentive to take risk in stocks
 - Yields (TBT) coming down slightly → inflation cooling due to lower consumer demand
 - Rate cuts possible if inflation cools, but may signal recessionary emergency action
 - Risk of "blowoff top" if dollar goes parabolic: market rallies 5–7% in a few weeks then crashes
- **Nvidia put credit spread trade idea:**
 - Sell the August 21st \$180 put / Buy the \$175 put
 - Risk \$400 to make \$100; ~80% probability of profit; ~25% return if Nvidia closes above \$180 on Aug 21
- **How Brandon and Greg met:** Both in the same trading group; Greg messaged Brandon, started sending trade alerts — Brandon was Greg's **very first trade alert subscriber**; built Victory Trades together starting late 2021 (now ~5 years)
- **Victory Trades membership:** Greg's trade alerts to phone daily + live futures trading every morning; free beginner courses included; link in description

Building Your Online Fitness Business: 5-Stage Blueprint [t=4629s](#)

- Brandon has been an online trainer since 2009–2010; built a 7-figure online training business
- Now teaches others; student example: **Jen** — a full-time nurse practitioner with two kids and a husband, zero online training experience or following → hit her **first \$10K month** after ~1.5 years with Brandon
- Student **Corey Armstrong** has made **over \$400,000 per year** for two consecutive years as an online trainer
- Key insight: "What got you out of Egypt will not get you to the promised land" — skills needed at each stage are different

Pricing Structure

Package	Duration	Minimum Price
Long-term	16 weeks	\$997
Monthly	Monthly	\$297/month
Weekly	Per week	\$80/week

- Math example: 25 clients × \$80/week × 52 weeks = **\$104,000/year**

- You don't need a massive following for 25 clients — they may already be following you
- In-person trainers at Equinox charge \$250–\$300/hour (no diet coaching included)
- Online training is arguably a *better* product because it includes daily diet accountability, which is the most important factor

🚩 Stage Summaries & Final Recap t=4810s

Stage 1 — Zero to \$5K/Month (0–15 clients)

- **Primary focus: Define your niche**
- Your niche = **Who** you help + **What problem** you solve + **How** you solve it
- Brandon's original niche: Men 20–30 who want to get ripped using HIIT cardio and intermittent fasting
 - Why that demographic: 20-somethings want to get ripped to attract women → marketing showed fit women around him
- Brandon's evolved niche (as he aged): Men 30–40, get ripped with keto and low-intensity cardio
 - Why that demographic: longevity, energy for kids, being a role model, maintaining attraction from wife
 - Known as "King Keto" on Instagram
 - Specialists command premium prices; clients can't price-shop a specialist
- **Traps:** Being a generalist, trying to help everyone, posting inconsistently, fear of being salesy
- **Action steps:**
 - Define target market (be specific on age, gender, lifestyle)
 - Define the specific problem you solve
 - Uncover the deep "why" behind that problem for your audience
 - Develop a unique methodology
 - Build ALL content around this niche
- **Bottleneck:** Positioning and messaging

Stage 2 — \$5K–\$10K/Month (15–30 clients)

- **Primary focus: Content and conversations (combos)**
- Post **2–3 Reels per day**, each with a **CTA (call to action)**
- Use a **"Profit PDF"** (lead magnet) instead of direct selling
 - Example: Corey Armstrong tells viewers to "Comment 50 for a copy of my free fat loss system"
 - AI automation (ManyChat or Go High Level) auto-DMs the PDF to commenters
 - Serves as a soft entry point into DM conversations
- **20 DM conversations per day** is the key metric
 - Distinction: outreach (no reply) ≠ conversation (two-way exchange)
 - "If you have 20 conversations per day, you cannot lose"
- AI can help: generate Reel topics, write scripts, handle DM responses

- **Traps:** Inconsistent posting, not hitting 20 conversations/day
- **Bottleneck:** Lead generation volume

Stage 3 — \$10K–\$20K/Month (30–60 clients)

- **Primary focus: Leverage (time management + AI + early hiring)**
- At this level most students still have a full-time job; time becomes the constraint
- AI tools to use:
 - CapCut or Descript for faster video editing
 - ManyChat or Go High Level for DM automation
- Consider hiring: a video editor, a DM setter
- **Trap:** Getting comfortable at \$10K and taking foot off the gas
 - Very common — students hover at this level for years due to comfort
 - Leads to boom-bust cycle: big month → coast → income drops → hustle → repeat
- **Bottleneck:** Time management; reluctance to hire
- Most students don't quit their day job until they consistently hit \$20K/month (due to health insurance, kids, etc.)

Stage 4 — \$20K–\$50K/Month (60–150 clients)

- **Primary focus: Building a real team**
- Annual equivalent: \$240K–\$600K/year ("multiple six figures, at least a quarter million")
- Hire:
 - Video editor
 - DM setter (books sales calls)
 - Assistant coach(es) to help manage clients
 - Possibly someone for accountability and program management
- Owner's job: content creation, marketing strategy, sales calls, team leadership
- Labor costs are modest — you keep **80–90% of profits**
- **Trap:** Waiting too long to hire, micromanaging, or thinking hiring costs too much
- **Bottleneck:** Trying to do everything yourself

Stage 5 — \$50K–\$100K/Month (150–300 clients)

- **Primary focus: Systems, scale, and leadership**
- Transition from operator to leader
- At this level, you often hire a **salesperson** — you're no longer on sales calls
- Owner's only jobs: content creation + team management + occasional client interaction
- Assistant coaches should know your methods well enough to operate independently
- Client retention directly = revenue: the longer you keep clients, the more money you make
- **Trap: Shiny object syndrome** — temptation to launch clothing lines, supplements, or side businesses

- Brandon has seen students make **\$300K/month** (the highest he's seen) purely from online training
- Stay focused; don't diversify prematurely
- Brandon helps students at every level — hiring strategies, finding Filipino virtual assistants (hard-working, low cost), documenting processes

"The skills that got you to \$5K per month are not the same skills that will get you to \$20K per month. What got you out of Egypt will not get you to the promised land."

- **Live training this Sunday at 2 PM EST** will go deeper on all stages with live Q&A
- Victory Talk podcast airs every **Tuesday and Thursday at 7:00 PM EST**